MILITARY SPECIFICATION
IGNITION ELEMENT, ELECTRIC, M21, ASSEMBLY

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers Ignition Element, Electric, M21, Assembly.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS
Military

MIL-A-2550	- Ammunition and Special Weapons, General Specification For
MIL-E-5272	- Environmental Testing, Aeronautical and Associated Equipment, General Specification For
MIL-P-19834	- Plates, Identification, Metal Foil, Adhesive Backed

STANDARDS
Military

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-109	- Quality Assurance Terms and Definitions
MIL-STD-202	- Test Methods for Electronic and Electrical Component Parts
MIL-STD-639	- Surface Roughness Values Preferred for Army Ordnance Materiel

DRAWINGS
U. S. Army Munitions Command

C10523566	- Ignition Element, Electric, M21, Assembly
C9204795	- Bag, Packing, Ammunition for Ignition Element, Electric, M21
C9204796	- Box, Packing, Ammunition for Ignition Element, Electric, M21
IEL-10523566	- Index to Inspection Equipment List for Ignition Element, Electric, M21, Assembly

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

FSC 1375

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3. REQUIREMENTS:

3.1 General.- Materials, parts and assemblies shall conform to the applicable drawings and referenced specifications.

3.2 Initial production sample.- Unless otherwise directed by the contracting officer an initial production sample shall be required.

3.3 Electrical.

3.3.1 The body assembly prior to assembly of the bridge wire shall not exhibit a leakage current in excess of 100 microamperes when subjected to 1000 volts of direct current, applied as follows:

a. Between each individual pin and the body
b. Between pins A and C.
c. Between pins A and B.
d. Between pins C and B.

3.3.2 Bridge circuit resistance.- The bridge circuit resistance of the ignition element shall be 0.11 ohm plus or minus .03 ohm.

3.4 Environmental.

3.4.1 Leakage.- The ignition element shall not exhibit a leak rate of .00001 ($1x10^{-5}$) cubic centimeters (cc) per second or more, when withstanding a dry leak test at a pressure differential of 14 pounds per square inch (psi).

3.4.2 Vibration.- The ignition element shall withstand vibration testing in accordance with MIL-E-5272, Procedure XII, with no evidence of disintegration of the propellant or derangement of components. The ignition element shall not autoignite, shall be safe to handle and shall meet the requirements of 3.3.2, 3.4.1, 3.6.1 and 3.6.2 at 70°F. following vibration testing.

3.5 Hydrostatic pressure.- The body assembly shall be capable of withstanding a hydrostatic pressure of 10,000 psi without any evidence of mechanical failure or leakage (see 6.5).

3.6 Functional.

3.6.1 Maximum no-fire stimulus.- The electric ignition element shall not fire when a direct current of 1.5 amperes is applied for 60 seconds at temperatures of -65°F., 70°F. and 200°F.

3.6.2 Fire stimulus.- After the application of the maximum no-fire stimulus current, the electric ignition element shall fire when direct current of 5.0 amperes is applied for a maximum of 50 milliseconds at the temperatures of -65°F., 70°F. and 200°F. The electric ignition element

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3.6.2 (Cont)

shall deliver a pressure of 2000 psi minimum to 6000 psi maximum, when fired into a 0.062 cubic inch volume at a temperature of 70°F. Pressures at -65°F and 200°F, shall be recorded for information only when fired into a 0.062 cubic inch volume. There shall be no evidence of blowback or mechanical failure of the glass to metal seal.

3.6.3 Minimum all-fire stimulus.- The electric ignition element shall fire when direct current of 3.5 amperes is applied for a maximum of 50 milliseconds at temperatures of -65°F, 70°F and 200°F. The electric ignition element shall deliver a pressure of 2000 psi minimum to 6000 psi maximum, when fired into a 0.062 cubic inch volume at a temperature of 70°F. Pressures at -65°F and 200°F, shall be recorded for information only when fired into a 0.062 cubic inch volume. There shall be no evidence of blowback or mechanical failure of the glass to metal seal.

3.7 Workmanship.- Workmanship shall be in accordance with the requirements of the applicable drawings, referenced specifications and the following:

3.7.1 Metal defects.- The metal part shall be free from cracks, splits, cold shuts, inclusions, porosity or any other metal defects.

3.7.2 Burr.- The ignition element shall not have a burr which might interfere with the assembly or function of the item or which might be injurious to personnel handling the item.

3.7.3 Foreign matter.- The part or assembly shall not contain chips, dirt, grease, oil, rust, corrosion or any other foreign matter.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

4.1 Responsibility for inspection.- Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Quality assurance terms and definitions.- Reference shall be made to MIL-STD-109 to define quality assurance terms used.

4.1.2 Inspection.- Inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-A-2550.

4.2 Initial production sample.- At the beginning of regular production, the supplier shall submit an initial production sample to a Government approved facility for evaluation. The sample shall consist of 112 ignition elements, 10 sets of parts and 5 body assemblies. The sample shall be subjected to the tests in 4.3.3. Test procedures shall be in accordance with 4.4. The sample shall be manufactured in the same manner, using

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4.2 (Cont)

the same materials, equipment, processes and procedures as used in regular production. All parts and materials, including packaging and packing, must be the same as used for regular production and shall be obtained from the same source of supply. The contractor shall inspect the sample in accordance with his inspection system. After inspection and provisional acceptance at source, the initial production sample shall be inspected at the Government approved facility for all requirements of the drawings and specifications. The Government reserves the right to require new initial production samples until such time as an acceptable sample is submitted.

4.3 Inspection provisions.

4.3.1 Lot.

4.3.1.1 Submission of product.- The product shall be submitted in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.3.1.2 Size of lot.- Unless otherwise specified by the procuring activity, a lot shall consist of 2400 ignition elements, maximum, exclusive of test samples and shall consist of:

a. Components produced by a homogeneous process.

b. Body assemblies (metal to ceramic seal) which have been heated in a furnace with the same process control.

c. Primer mixture from not more than one lot.

d. Loading produced by a homogeneous process.

4.3.2 Examination.- One hundred percent examination shall be performed for all critical defects. Examination for major and minor defects shall be performed on a defect basis in accordance with the classification of defects, using the sampling plans and criteria in tables I and II. For an individual defect (single characteristic) the criteria in table I shall be used. For total defects within a major or minor group, the criteria in table II shall be used. All nonconforming material shall be rejected. Inspection for labels shall be in accordance with MIL-P-19834. Four power (4X) magnification may be used in performing visual examination for such defects as burr and foreign matter.

Table I

Lot Size	Sample Size	Acceptance Number Major	Minor
1 - 300	100% Examination	-	-
301 - 1,300	110	1	2
1,301 - 3,200	150	2	3
3,201 - 8,000	225	3	4
8,001 - 22,000	300	4	5

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Table II

Total Allowable Defects per Sample Size

No. Defects in Class	Sample Size for Major Defects			
	110	150	225	300
2 - 3	1	2	3	4
4 - 7	2	3	4	5
8 - 19	3	4	5	7
20 - 43	4	5	8	10
Over 43	6	8	11	14

	Sample Size for Minor Defects			
	110	150	225	300
2 - 3	2	3	4	5
4 - 7	3	4	5	7
8 - 16	4	5	8	10
17 - 48	6	8	11	14
Over 48	8	11	17	20

4.3.2.1 Body Assembly, Drawing C10523567, covering a detail of Drawing C10523566.

Defect	Method of Inspection
CRITICAL	
1. Improper assembly	Visual
2. Any part missing	Visual
3. Glass insulator not flush or below surface "A"	Visual
4. Spot welding of bridge wire missing or improper	Visual
MAJOR	
101. True position of pins with large cavity	Gage
102. Depth of small cavity	Gage
103. Depth from face to end of inserted pin	Gage
104. Depth from face to end of pin protruding through sleeve	Gage
MINOR	
201. Marking missing, incorrect or illegible	Visual

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4.3.2.2 Body, Drawing C10523568, covering a detail of Drawing C10523566.

	Defect	Method of Inspection
CRITICAL		
	None defined.	
MAJOR		
101.	Pitch diameter of thread, min	Gage
102.	Major diameter of thread, min	Gage
103.	Concentricity of flange and shoulder with large cavity	Gage
104.	Concentricity of body between flange and shoulder with large cavity	Gage
105.	Concentricity of pitch diameter of thread with small cavity	Gage
106.	Concentricity of counterbore with small cavity	Gage
107.	Concentricity of thread pilot with counterbore	Gage
108.	Concentricity of small cavity with large cavity	Gage
109.	Concentricity of holes with large cavity	Gage
110.	Symmetry of small flange and shoulder with large cavity and holes	Gage
111.	Symmetry of large flange and shoulder with large cavity and holes	Gage
112.	Diameter of counterbore, max	Gage
113.	Diameter of undercut, min	Gage
114.	Depth of counterbore, max	Gage
115.	Metal defective	Visual
116.	Burr	Visual
117.	Foreign matter	Visual
MINOR		
201.	Pitch diameter of thread, max	Gage
202.	Diameter of holes	Gage
203.	Diameter across flange	Gage
204.	Diameter of body between flange and shoulder	Gage
205.	Diameter of large cavity	Gage
206.	Diameter of undercut, max	Gage
207.	Diameter of small cavity	Gage
208.	Diameter of counterbore, min	Gage
209.	Diameter of thread pilot	Gage
210.	Depth of counterbore, min	Gage
211.	Depth to base of small cavity	Gage
212.	Depth to base of large cavity	Gage

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4.3.2.2 (Cont) MINOR

	Defect	Method of Inspection
213.	Length from flange to shoulder	Gage
214.	Length of thread pilot	Gage
215.	Total length	Gage
216.	Width of large flange and shoulder	Gage
217.	Width of small flange and shoulder	Gage
218.	Width of undercut	Gage
219.	Thickness of flange	Gage
220.	Location of hexagon area from each end	Gage
221.	Radius or chamfer missing or incorrect	Visual
222.	Surface finish improper	Visual

4.3.2.3 Pin, Drawing B10523569, covering a detail of Drawing C10523566.

CRITICAL
None defined.

	MAJOR	
101.	Diameter, min	Gage
102.	Total length, min	Gage
103.	Metal defective	Visual
104.	Burr	Visual
105.	Foreign matter	Visual

	MINOR	
201.	Diameter, max	Gage
202.	Total length, max	Gage
203.	Ends incorrect	Visual
204.	Surface finish improper	Visual

4.3.2.4 Double Pin, Drawing B10523570, covering a detail of Drawing C10523566.

CRITICAL
None defined.

	MAJOR	
101.	Diameter, min	Gage
102.	Total length, min	Gage
103.	Metal defective	Visual
104.	Burr	Visual
105.	Foreign matter	Visual

	MINOR	
201.	Diameter, max	Gage
202.	Total length, max	Gage
203.	Width from center to center at open end	Gage
204.	Surface finish improper	Visual

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4.3.2.5 Insulator, Drawing B10523571, covering a detail of Drawing C10523566.

Defect	Method of Inspection
CRITICAL	
None defined.	
MAJOR	
101. Diameter of hole, max	Gage
102. Total length, min	Gage
103. Material defective	Visual
104. Burr	Visual
105. Foreign matter	Visual
MINOR	
201. Diameter of body	Gage
202. Diameter of hole, min	Gage
203. Total length, max	Gage
204. Surface finish improper	Visual

4.3.2.6 Sleeve, Drawing B10523572, covering a detail of Drawing C10523566.

CRITICAL	
None defined.	
MAJOR	
101. True position of holes with diameter	Gage
102. Diameter of holes	Gage
103. Diameter of body, min	Gage
104. Depth of cavity, max	Gage
105. Width of slot	Gage
106. Total length, min	Gage
107. Material defective	Visual
108. Burr	Visual
109. Foreign matter	Visual
MINOR	
201. Diameter of body, max	Gage
202. Depth of cavity, min	Gage
203. Total length	Gage
204. Radius missing or incorrect	Visual
205. Surface finish improper	Visual

4.3.2.7 Disc, Outer, Drawing B10523573, covering a detail of Drawing C10523566.

CRITICAL
None defined.

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Defect	Method of Inspection
MAJOR	
101. Wrinkled or not otherwise smooth	Visual
102. Material defective	Visual
103. Foreign matter	Visual
MINOR	
201. Diameter	Gage
202. Thickness	Gage

4.3.2.8 Disc, Inner, Drawing B10523574, covering a detail of Drawing C10523566.

CRITICAL	
None defined.	
MAJOR	
101. Wrinkled or not otherwise smooth	Gage
102. Material defective	Visual
103. Foreign matter	Visual
MINOR	
201. Diameter	Gage
202. Thickness	Gage
203. Wrinkled or not otherwise smooth	Visual

4.3.2.9 Sleeve, Drawing B10524848, covering a detail of Drawing C10523566.

CRITICAL	
None defined.	
MAJOR	
None defined.	
MINOR	
201. Length of taper	Gage
202. Width of end at taper	Gage
203. Width	Gage
204. Thickness	Gage
205. Material defective	Visual
206. Foreign matter	Visual

4.3.2.10 Shunt, Drawing B10534849, covering a detail of Drawing C10523566.

CRITICAL	
None defined.	
MAJOR	
101. Metal defective	Visual
102. Burr	Visual
103. Foreign matter	Visual

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4.3.2.10 (Cont)

Defect	Method of Inspection
MINOR	
201. Diameter	Gage
202. Diameter of wire	Gage
203. Total length	Gage
204. Ends incorrect	Visual

4.3.2.11 Assembly, Ignition Element, Electric, M21, Drawing C10523566.

CRITICAL	
1. Any part missing	X-ray
2. Improper assembly	X-ray
3. Primer cavity not filled flush with surface "A"	Visual
4. Marking missing, incorrect or illegible	Visual
MAJOR	
101. Thread damaged or not full	Visual
102. Foreign matter	Visual
MINOR	
201. Length from face to hex surface	Gage
202. Total length	Gage
203. Paint missing from hex faces	Visual

4.3.2.12 Bag, Packing, Drawing C9204795.

CRITICAL	
None defined.	
MAJOR	
None defined.	
MINOR	
201. Chipboard missing	Visual
202. Chipboard not taped	Visual
203. Spacing on chipboard incorrect	Visual
204. Contents loose	Manual and Visual
205. Number of units incorrect	Visual
206. Bag not properly sealed or broken	Visual
207. Marking missing, incorrect or illegible	Visual

4.3.2.13 Box, Wooden Packing, Drawing C9204796.

CRITICAL
None defined.

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4.3.2.13 (Cont)

Defect	Method of Inspection
MAJOR	
None defined.	
MINOR	
201. Contents loose	Manual and Visual
202. Contents of box exposed	Visual
203. Strapping missing, loose, broken or improperly assembled	Visual
204. Box damaged	Visual
205. Number of units incorrect	Visual
206. Marking missing, incorrect or illegible	Visual
207. Car seal missing, unsealed or improperly positioned	Visual

4.3.3 Inspection testing.- The following tests shall be performed in accordance with the provisions of 4.4:

4.3.3.1 Electrical.

4.3.3.1.1 Dielectric withstanding voltage.- Each body assembly, prior to assembly of bridge wire, shall be subjected to the test. Failure of any unit to comply with the requirements of 3.3.1 shall be cause for rejection of the unit.

4.3.3.1.2 Bridge circuit resistance.- Each ignition element shall be subjected to the test. Failure of any unit to comply with the requirements of 3.3.2 shall be cause for rejection of the unit.

4.3.3.2 Environmental.

4.3.3.2.1 Leakage.- Each ignition element shall be subjected to the test. Failure of any unit to comply with the requirements of 3.4.1 shall be cause for rejection of the unit.

4.3.3.2.2 Vibration.- Twelve ignition elements of the initial production sample shall be subjected to the test. Failure of any unit to comply with the requirements of 3.4.2 shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Any change in the loading process shall be cause for selecting a new sample for submission to the vibration test.

4.3.3.3 Hydrostatic pressure.- Five ignition elements of each lot shall be subjected to the test. Failure of any unit to comply with the requirements of 3.5 shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.3.3.4 Functional.- The following tests shall be performed by the Government: One hundred ignition elements shall be selected from each lot, assembled into a 0.062 cubic inch firing chamber and temperature conditioned in accordance with 4.4.5 and table III.

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4.3.3.4 (Cont)

Table III

Temperature	No. of Units
-65°F to -70°F	20
65°F to 75°F	60
195°F to 200°F	20

4.3.3.4.1 Maximum no-fire stimulus.- Fifty ignition elements (30 at 65° to 75°F, 10 at -65° to -70°F and 10 at 195° to 200°F) of each lot shall be tested. Failure of any unit to comply with the requirements of 3.6.1 shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.3.3.4.2 Fire stimulus.- The 50 ignition elements tested in 4.3.3.4.1 shall be used for this test. Failure of any unit to comply with 3.6.2 shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.3.3.4.3 Minimum all-fire stimulus.- The remaining 50 conditioned elements (30 at 65° to 75°F, 10 at -65° to -75°F, and 10 at 195° to 200°F) shall be used for this test. Failure of any unit to comply with the requirements of 3.6.3 shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.3.4 Inspection equipment.- The examination and tests shall be made using equipment as listed on IEL-10523566.

4.4 Test methods and procedures.- All tests shall be performed on units which have been visually and dimensionally accepted.

4.4.1 Electrical.

4.4.1.1 Dielectric withstanding voltage.- A dielectric withstanding voltage of 1000 + 50 volts dc, shall be applied between all pins and body, and between pins A and C, pins A and B, and pins C and B, prior to the assembly of the bridge wire. In each test the leakage current shall be measured within an accuracy of 5 percent. The test shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-202, Method 301.

4.4.1.2 Bridge circuit resistance.- The bridge circuit resistance of the bridge circuit shall be measured, using a test circuit which subjects the bridge circuit to a current of less than 50 milliamperes. The test shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-202, Method 303.

4.4.2 Environmental.

4.4.2.1 Leakage.- The leak test shall be conducted using a leak detector of sufficient sensitivity to ascertain if the ignition elements meet the leak rate requirement.

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4.4.2.2 Vibration.- The ignition elements shall be subjected to the test in accordance with MIL-E-5272, Procedure XII. The sample shall be divided into 3 groups of four units each. The first group shall be tested with disc up; the second group with disc down, and the third group with axis horizontal. If the ignition elements have successfully met the requirements of the vibration test they shall be subjected to test outlined in 4.4.1.2 and 4.4.2.1. The ignition elements then shall be assembled into a 0.062 cubic inch firing chamber and temperature conditioned at 65°F. to 75°F., in accordance with 4.4.5. After temperature conditioning, the ignition element shall be subjected to tests in the following order: (1) 4.4.4.1 and (2) 4.4.4.2.

4.4.3 Hydrostatic pressure.- The test shall be conducted using a hydrostatic test apparatus capable of subjecting the body assembly to an internal pressure of 10,000 psi for a minimum of 10 seconds.

4.4.4 Functional.

4.4.4.1 Maximum no-fire stimulus.- A dc current pulse of 1.50 amperes minus .05 ampere shall be applied to the bridge circuit of each electric ignition element for a period of 60 seconds plus two seconds.

4.4.4.2 Fire stimulus.- After a time lapse of 4 minutes plus or minus one minute, after successfully completing the test in 4.4.4.1, a direct current (dc) pulse of 5.0 amperes plus 0.05 ampere shall be applied to the bridge circuit of the ignition element. The time from current application until the ignition element fires and the maximum pressure attained within the firing chamber, shall be measured and recorded. Temperature reconditioning is required when more than 5 minutes lapse after the maximum no-fire stimulus test.

4.4.4.3 Minimum all-fire stimulus.- A dc current pulse of 3.50 amperes plus 0.05 ampere shall be applied to the bridge circuit of each ignition element. The time from current application until the ignition element fires and the maximum pressure attained within the firing chamber, shall be measured and recorded.

4.4.5 Temperature conditioning.- The temperature within the propellant shall be considered as the conditioning temperature and will be determined by means of a thermocouple located at the center of the propellant charge of a specimen ignition element. The conditioning time shall be a minimum of one hour longer than the time necessary to bring the specimen ignition element to the required temperature. Temperature reconditioning of the ignition elements shall be accomplished if the ignition elements are not tested within 5 minutes after removal from the conditioning chamber, except as noted in 4.4.4.2.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packing and marking.- Packing and marking shall be in accordance with Drawings C8887524 and C8887525.

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5.2 Data cards.- Data card information shall be in accordance with MIL-A-2550.

6. NOTES

6.1 Loading data:

Primer Mixture FA 957 1.2 to 1.5 grains (advisory) Drawing A10523576

Ball Propellant, WC 850, 0.9 to 1.1 grains (advisory)

6.2 Safety.- Metallic shunts shall be used between all pins and body on all ignition elements while being handled or in shipment. The only time metallic shunts are not used is when the ignition element is being tested or is in the device of its intended application.

6.3 Recommended firing circuit.- A minimum firing current of 5.0 amperes is recommended for the "in field" use of this item.

6.4 Recommended internal pressure.- It is recommended that this device be used in a system which will not subject the ignition element to a sustained pressure, after firing, in excess of 10,000 psi.

6.5 Mechanical failure is defined as any deformation or breakage of any part, the occurrence of which is other than a design function.

Custodian:

Army - MU

Preparing activity:

Army - MU

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 119-R004

INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity.

SPECIFICATION

ORGANIZATION | CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NO. | QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED | DOLLAR AMOUNT $

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity)* | DATE

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